

153 Make conkers

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Conkers is a children's game that has been played in Britain and Ireland for about 200 years. All you need to play are two players and some horse chestnuts.



What you need

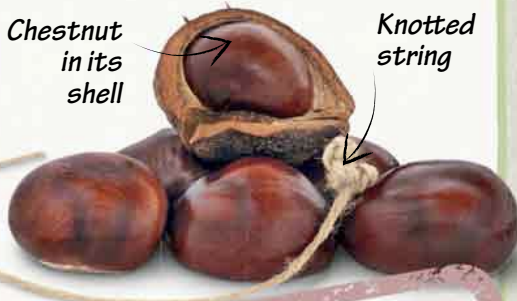
- Horse chestnuts
- Distilled white vinegar
- Skewer or bradawl
- String or strong thread about 12 in (30 cm) long



1 Cover the chestnut with vinegar and soak it for two minutes. (Note: Have an adult help you with all these steps!)



2 Preheat the oven to 425°F (250°C). Bake the chestnuts for 1½ minutes. Use oven mitts to take them out, and let cool.



3 When the chestnuts are cool enough to handle, pierce each one. Pull the string through each one and tie a knot securely. Ready, set... play!

Be careful when playing conkers—pieces can fly off when the chestnuts break.

154 Play a game of conkers

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Toss a coin to see who starts. Player one takes three strikes at player two's conker, then hangs his or her conker. Player two goes next. The winner breaks the other player's conker.

Hold the striking conker in your fingers

Hang the conker to be struck

